



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cascade View Christian School
School Website: <https://cascadeviewfmc.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Classicality Audit Report: Austin Classical School

Website audited: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (Austin, TX) presents a robust classical, Christian identity centered on cultivating wisdom and virtue through the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The site makes explicit use of the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Latin, great books/great conversation, memory work (songs/recitation), and discussion/debate culminating in thesis defense. It also foregrounds its Christian telos ("glorify Jesus Christ") and theological integration ("under the sovereignty of God through theology"). Evidence for faculty formation/portrait is thinner than other areas, but mission alignment with classical pedagogy is strong across the board.

Key strengths - Clear, repeated emphasis on wisdom, virtue, and the transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty). - Concrete Trivium implementation (Latin, logic, rhetoric) and "great books/great conversation" framing. - Lower-school songs/memorization; logic-stage debate/discussion; rhetoric-stage thesis defense/eloquence.

Area to strengthen - Make faculty formation explicit (e.g., a "Portrait of a Teacher," stated mentorship model, and ongoing classical pedagogy training) to fully match classical faculty ideals in the Six Elements framework.

Note on rubric and method: The keyword analysis and category ratings below follow the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" positive/negative indicators for each category (religious foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, parents/community). Each section lists keywords found in the school's materials, compares them to the framework lexicon, quantifies positive vs. negative hits, and assigns a rating.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords/phrases found (from the school's site)

- "Glorify Jesus Christ"; "classical, Christian education"; "co-laboring with families"; "under the sovereignty of God through theology"; "truth, goodness, and beauty"; "wisdom," "virtue."

2) Mapping to Six Elements indicators

- Positive indicators matched: theology, faith and reason, Christian worldview; truth/goodness/beauty; wisdom/virtue; metaphysical order under God.
- Liturgical/communal practices (chapel, daily prayer, hymnody) not explicitly stated on the site excerpts reviewed.

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: 8 (truth, goodness, beauty, wisdom, virtue, Christian, Jesus Christ, theology)
- Negative hits: 0 (no “religiously neutral,” “secular,” or relativist signals)
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage estimate: 0.67 (2 of 3 sub-themes strongly evidenced: moral realism and theology; liturgical practice not explicit)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords/phrases found

- “Cultivate wisdom and virtue”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”; “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation... eternal purpose”; “great conversation.”

2) Mapping to Six Elements indicators

- Positive: cultivation of wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information (de-emphasis on job training).
- Negative signals like “21st-century skills”/“college and career ready” absent.

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: 7 (wisdom, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, formation, great conversation)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage estimate: 1.00 (all three sub-themes clearly present)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keywords/phrases found

- Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; Latin (5th–8th); formal logic (8th); rhetoric (10th); great books/great ideas/great conversation; integrated curriculum/interrelation of all knowledge.

2) Mapping to Six Elements indicators

- Positive: seven liberal arts (Trivium explicitly; Quadrivium implied via integration), Great Books/primary sources, integrated/harmony of subjects. “Wonder” is implied but not named explicitly.
- No “social studies replaces history” or STEM-first/programmatic jargon.

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: 9 (Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, great books, great conversation, integration/interrelation, rhetoric instruction)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage estimate: 0.75 (3 of 4 sub-themes strongly evidenced; “wonder” not explicitly named)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY / TEACHING METHODS

1) Keywords/phrases found

- Lower school: “memorization, recitation, and songs”; Logic stage: “debate and discussion”; Rhetoric stage: “thesis defense,” “eloquent written and oral communication”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful.”

2) Mapping to Six Elements indicators

- Positive: memorization/recitation/chanting; Socratic discussion/debate; rhetoric/oratory; contemplation/restful learning gestures (via contemplation of the transcendentals).
- Imitation/apprenticeship not named explicitly on the pages reviewed.

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: 9 (memorization, recitation, songs, debate, discussion, thesis defense, eloquence, rhetoric/oratory, contemplation)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage estimate: 0.75 (3 of 4 sub-themes clearly present)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords/phrases found

- “Head of School who loves Jesus and loves people”; “talented and dedicated teachers who enjoy serving God by teaching... using the classical approach”; employment page (qualifications listed, but not captured in detail).

2) Mapping to Six Elements indicators

- Partially matches “teachers as models of virtue”/“mentors,” but the site samples lack an explicit “Portrait of a Teacher,” “faculty of friends,” or stated faculty formation in classical pedagogy.

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: 2 (teachers serving God; classical approach)
- Negative hits: 0 (no “facilitator-only”/ed-jargon signals observed)
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage estimate: 0.40 (roughly 1–2 of ~4 desired cues evidenced)

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords/phrases found

- “Co-laboring with families”; campus tours and prospective parent meetings; direct admissions contact; recommended reading to grow understanding of classical, Christian education.

2) Mapping to Six Elements indicators

- Positive: partnership with parents; parent formation (recommended reading/resources); open campus/hospitality.
- No “parent-as-customer/minimal involvement” language observed.

3) Quantitative keyword tally

- Positive hits: 4 (partnership/co-laboring, campus access, parent meetings, recommended reading/formation)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage estimate: 0.67 (2 of 3 sub-themes strongly evidenced)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings: C1 CLASSICAL; C2 CLASSICAL; C3 CLASSICAL; C4 CLASSICAL; C5 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; C6 CLASSICAL.
- Overall: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The site explicitly embraces the classical-Christian telos (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue and wisdom), implements the Trivium with Latin/logic/rhetoric, uses memory work and Socratic discussion culminating in thesis defense, and partners with families. Faculty ideals are implied but would benefit from a more explicit classical faculty portrait and formation program.

What would move the needle (Faculty) - Publish a "Portrait of a Teacher" and "Portrait of a Graduate." - Describe faculty formation (e.g., great books seminars, classical pedagogy training, mentorship/collegial culture). - Name teachers explicitly as mentors/models of virtue and "the living curriculum," aligned to classical virtue ethics.

Evidence Appendix (selected excerpts)

- Mission: "Austin Classical School exists to glorify Jesus Christ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students... classical, Christian education."
- Method: contemplation of the True, Good, Beautiful; great books/great conversation; employ the Trivium.
- Trivium details: Latin 5–8; formal logic (8th); rhetoric (10th); thesis defense; integrated learning "under the sovereignty of God through theology."
- Lower/Upper pedagogy: "memorization, recitation, and songs" (Grammar); "debate and discussion" (Logic); "thesis defense... eloquent written and oral communication" (Rhetoric).
- Parent partnership and access: "co-laboring with families," tours/prospective parent meetings; direct email for Admissions & Marketing Director.

Framework used for scoring: Six Essential Elements positive/negative keyword indicators across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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